

Julien Crésus-Ashton

SENIOR INTERACTION DESIGNER

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SC cleared

Paris-born, London-based interaction designer with over 8 years' experience designing public services and digital products across government, financial services and consumer products. I've introduced process improvements that became formally adopted standards, worked as the connective tissue across large multidisciplinary teams, and consistently delivered accessible, evidence-based design under real constraints.

EXPERIENCE

Cognizant

Nov 2023 – Present

Senior Interaction Designer

- Led interaction design for HMRC's Welsh Council Tax service, translating complex policy into clear, GDS-compliant journeys that users could complete without support.
- Designed for two further DEFRA-family services: Natural England's protected sites monitoring service and APHA's People Planner, replacing paper field workflows and spreadsheet planning with digital tools tested with expert users (2024–2025).
- Introduced trio writing and weekly review processes that were formally adopted into the service's alpha assessment as the standard approach for bilingual content delivery.
- Built and maintained a shared bilingual component glossary, establishing reusable UI patterns for labels, buttons and error messages used consistently across the team.
- Defined personas, interaction models and service flows to GDS standards, establishing WCAG 2.2 as a team baseline, and partnered with research across alpha and beta to improve task completion in key journeys.

DAM Digital

Apr 2022 – Nov 2023

Senior UX/UI Designer

- Led UX strategy for clients including McArthurGlen, Rethink Mental Illness, Shy Aviation and Crisis, balancing user needs with business goals to shape clear, actionable design decisions.
- Led end-to-end design delivery in Figma, from discovery through to handoff, working closely with product managers and engineers.
- Ensured accessibility and design system standards were applied consistently across projects, while managing client relationships through regular reviews and feedback.
- Mentored a junior user researcher, supporting their development in Figma and UX practice.

Methods

Feb 2019 – Apr 2022

UX Designer

- Designed end-to-end services for programmes including Every Mind Matters, the National Funding Formula and the Ministry of Defence, applying GDS standards across discovery, alpha and beta.
- Built coded prototypes using React and the GOV.UK Design System, enabling faster testing and collaboration than static tools allowed.
- Facilitated workshops bringing research, product and engineering together, aligning teams on what to build and how to deliver it.

Société Générale Design

Sep 2017 – Dec 2018

UX/UI Designer Trainee

- Designed for trading platforms and internal innovation programmes across low- and high-fidelity, using Adobe XD and Sketch within agile delivery teams.
- Ran co-creation sessions with product owners, end users and IT teams to validate concepts early and reduce rework.

SKILLS

Core

- Interaction Design
- User-Centred Design
- Service & Journey Mapping

Delivery

- Prototyping & Wireframing
- Workshop facilitation
- Stakeholder Management

Standards & Tools

- GOV.UK Design System & Prototype Kit
- WCAG 2.2 Accessibility
- HTML · CSS · JavaScript (React)
- Figma · Sketch · Adobe Suite
- Miro · JIRA · Confluence

EDUCATION

MSc UX Design

Kingston University, London
2018 · Thesis: Autism awareness app in WebVR

BA Web Design

Epitech Digital, Paris
2016

LANGUAGES

French (*Native*)
English (*Bilingual*)
German (*Basic*)